

STUDY MUSE AI

The Active Recall & Study Method Kit

The research-backed techniques that actually build
memory — versus the ones that just feel productive.

*"Highlighting feels like learning. Testing yourself is
learning."*

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WELCOME

Why Some Studying Doesn't Stick

Read this first

Rereading notes and highlighting text create a feeling of familiarity that's easy to mistake for actually knowing the material — but recognizing something when you see it is a much lower bar than being able to produce it from memory on an exam. This kit covers four methods that close that gap: active recall, spaced repetition, the Feynman technique, and interleaving.

Active Recall

Test yourself instead of rereading

Instead of reading your notes again, close them and try to write or say everything you remember about the topic. Then check what you missed. The struggle to recall is what builds the memory — rereading skips that struggle entirely.

Topic	What you recalled without notes	What you missed

AI companion prompt: "Quiz me on [topic] using active recall — ask me one question at a time, don't give me the answer until I respond, and tell me honestly if my answer was incomplete."

Spaced Repetition

Review at increasing intervals, not all at once

Reviewing material once and never again means you'll likely forget most of it. Reviewing it repeatedly right before the exam is inefficient. Spaced repetition reviews material right before you'd naturally forget it — spacing reviews further apart each time you get it right.

Topic learned	Review 1 (next day)	Review 2 (3 days later)	Review 3 (1 week later)

The Feynman Technique

If you can't explain it simply, you don't know it yet

Step	What to do
1	Pick a concept and explain it out loud as if teaching a beginner
2	Notice where you stumble, use jargon, or go vague
3	Go back to your source material and fill in exactly that gap
4	Explain it again — simpler and more complete this time

Try It Now

Pick your hardest topic. Explain it below as simply as you can, like you're teaching a 12-year-old.

AI companion prompt: "I'm going to explain [topic] to you like you're a beginner. Here's my explanation: [your explanation]. Point out anywhere I was vague, used jargon without explaining it, or got something wrong."

Interleaving

Mix related topics instead of mastering one at a time

Studying one topic exhaustively before moving to the next feels organized, but mixing related topics or problem types together (interleaving) trains you to recognize which method or concept applies — which is exactly what an exam actually tests.

Build an Interleaved Practice Set

Instead of doing 20 problems from the same topic in a row, mix 5–6 topics into one practice session and shuffle the order.

Session	Topics mixed in

Matching Method to Material

Quick reference

Material	Best method(s)
Vocabulary, dates, definitions	Active recall + spaced repetition (flashcards)
Concepts, theories, "why" questions	Feynman technique
Problem sets, calculations	Interleaving + active recall
Anything you'll need long-term (not just for this exam)	Spaced repetition, ongoing

METHODS THAT WORK

Studying Smarter, Not Just Longer

Four techniques, backed by how memory actually
works — not just what feels productive.

*Continue with the Study AI Prompt Kit to put these into
practice with AI as your study partner.*

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